

Scott Kurz

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<https://scott1.github.io> (*career story + projects*)

Profile

Senior software engineer with 20+ years of experience building complex systems across startups and enterprise environments (Immunet, Sourcefire, Cisco, Symantec, TELUS).

Strong background in backend systems, endpoint security, and distributed architectures, with a growing focus on roles that combine technical depth with product thinking, team alignment, and real-world impact.

Known for simplifying complex systems, aligning teams, and helping turn ideas into working solutions.

Current Direction

Interested in roles at the intersection of **technology, people, and product**, including:

- Technical Program Manager / Technical Lead
- Product Manager (Technical / AI-focused)
- Solutions Engineer / Solutions Architect
- Applied AI / AI Product Engineering

Particularly interested in companies using AI to solve meaningful problems.

Modern Development Approach

- Leverage AI-assisted development tools (LLMs, Codex-style workflows) to rapidly prototype and build solutions across unfamiliar stacks
 - Combine 20+ years of engineering experience with AI tools to dramatically increase speed, flexibility, and scope
 - Focus on system design, problem framing, and validation rather than manual implementation of every component
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Key Strengths

- Systems thinking and architecture design
 - Cross-team alignment and communication
 - Translating complex technical systems into clear understanding
 - Operating effectively in ambiguity and fast-changing environments
 - Rapid learning across new domains and technologies
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Technical Foundation

Languages: C, C++, C#, Go, Python, Ruby, Perl, JavaScript, HTML, CSS

Cloud: AWS (Lambda, DynamoDB, S3, SQS, API Gateway)

Systems: Linux/Unix, Windows

Other: Distributed systems, observability (CloudWatch, X-Ray), Docker, Git

Experience

Cisco Systems (via Sourcefire / Immunet)

Senior Software Engineer

2011 – 2023

Worked across both endpoint security software and backend cloud systems for Cisco Secure Endpoint (AMP).

System & Product Contributions

- Developed endpoint agent (C/C++) with focus on performance, reliability, and security
- Built telemetry, detection reporting, and event visibility systems
- Contributed to backend services using Go and AWS, designing for scale and reliability

Cross-Team Leadership & Alignment

- Took on key coordination role during large cross-team project after departure of senior team members
- Helped align multiple teams, clarify direction, and maintain delivery under uncertainty
- Frequently stepped into informal leadership roles to bridge gaps between teams

Architecture & Communication

- Used system diagrams and architectural thinking to improve alignment and accelerate development

- Helped onboard engineers and explain complex system interactions across teams

Key Insight

- Strong systems require not just implementation, but clarity, ownership, and alignment across teams
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Symantec Corporation

Software Engineer

2008 – 2011

- Owned installer systems (C++, InstallShield, MSBuild)
- Built and maintained deployment and upgrade flows
- Contributed to client-side systems and local data storage

Key Insight

- Structure improves consistency but does not guarantee clarity or shared understanding
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TELUS

Business Analyst / Developer

Early Career

- Automated repetitive operational workflows, dramatically increasing productivity
- Contributed to internal “Quick Wins” team delivering rapid automation solutions
- Built tools that eliminated manual processes across teams

Key Insight

- Automation can transform systems — but how it is implemented matters just as much as what is built
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Education

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science (Distinction)

University of Calgary
